



## The Berners-Lee Legacy

The year is 1989, a brilliant young computer engineer going by the name Tim Berners-Lee, joins one of the world's most premier science research institute, CERN. Our protagonist appalled by the condition he witnesses there; data is everywhere but it is stored in myriad documents but in different ways. He decides to devise a system to let people access the document in the same way anywhere on the network. After months of prodding, pleading and toiling on the then latest system – NeXTSTEP, he was finally able to deliver the first



web server and web browser. The rest is history. In act of supreme madness/benevolence he gives his invention, the “World Wide Web” away to the world for free. Sir Berners-Lee has since setup and spear-heads the World Wide Web Consortium(W3C), and continues to shape the future of the web.



## Oscars of the Internet

It doesn't have ladies draped in sequins, traipsing down the aisle with shorter gentlemen in tag, neither the histrionics nor the scale. All the same, the Oscars of the Internet, or the Webby Awards as they are better known as perhaps the most prestigious recognition that a web site can get. Given out by the International Academy of Digital Arts & Sciences for excellence on the



Internet including Websites, Interactive Advertising, Online Film & Video and more recently Mobile content. The awards are famous for the fact that they limit the acceptance speech to 5 words though many have exceeded that. One of the more famous is Al Gore's speech when accepting a Webby Special Achievement Award – “Please don't recount this vote”. It has also received some flak for the pay-to-attend (winners and nominees also) and the pay-to-enter policy; which the management defends saying that it keeps the pressures subjected by sponsorship at bay.



## LAMP

LAMP is an acronym for Linux, Apache HTTP Server, MySQL and PHP (or sometimes Perl or Python). Widely regarded as the most viable configuration as far as servers go. This can be perhaps attributed to the fact that Linux as a platform is more stable, secure and compatible with other server-oriented platforms like SPARC and

BSD. MySQL and PHP combined can deploy any high performance web applications. Though sometimes they are replaced by PostgreSQL and Perl/Python depending on the application being deployed. What makes this open source web server architecture a favourite among web developers, is it's infinite hackability(pun not intended), extensibility and flexibility. No wonder, 65% of the websites on the Internet run on some permutation of the basic LAMP stack.



## Quora

Founded by two former Facebook employees, Quora is a question-answer web site which is created, edited and maintained by the users. What sets it apart from a myriad other such web sites



is exclusivity and insistence on the participants using real identities. Quora users can upvote or downvote an answer, thus determine its existence in the discussion. It was lauded by nearly all the major newspapers and blogs to be the next best thing on Internet. Apart from occasional ranting by users against the moderators who seem to wield god-like powers and egos to match, it is an excellent place to satiate your curiosity.



## Memes

Memes seem to come up when there is a combinashun of lots of spare time; wiiyrd pictures or videos and even moar wiiyrd coments and capshuns. A common thread is the complete and utter anihilashun of the English language wii know. From photoshopped pictures of cyoot cats zleeping in bed or eating ur foodz, icanhascheezburger, hotdogz, orly! owlz, aybabtu, rage comicz, pedobear, and duck-rolz. Memes are two numerus to count and more keep surfacing every day, but who givez a damn as long as there r cyoot catz and lulz degrading your language with their ignorance and apathy.



## 50 gms

This is the weight of the Internet at any one moment, according to Vsauce, a sci/tech YouTube channel. Vsauce arrived on the figure by calculating the weight of all the electrons in the electricity required to make the internet work – assuming 75-100 million servers supporting the internet, and not including the home PCs running web servers.